

ASM IIT Delhi Student Chapter Constitution

ARTICLE I: ORGANIZATION NAME AND AFFILIATION

Section A: Name - This organization shall be known as the *American Society for Microbiology Indian Institute of Technology Delhi Student Chapter (ASM-IITD)*.

Section B: University Affiliation – This chapter, as an official entity of Indian Institute of Technology Delhi will adhere to all rules and regulations for chapters at Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IITD) for any and all chapter activities.

ARTICLE II: ORGANIZATION GOALS

The purpose of this organization shall be to:

1. Promote student interest in Microbiology and support the advancement of microbiology related education and research at Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (IITD).
2. Promote and explain the benefits and value of ASM membership to students, postdocs, and early career scientists at IITD.
3. Promote K-12 student interest in microbiology through educational outreach initiatives by ASM-IITD.
4. Provide aid and professional development opportunities for students in Microbiology at the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi with respect to academic curriculum, research, employment.
5. Promote student participation in local, state and national ASM meetings and activities.

ARTICLE III: MEMBERSHIP AND DUES

Section A: Eligibility - Membership is open to all undergraduate, graduate and postgraduate students at Indian Institute of Technology Delhi who are currently enrolled in programmes related to microbiology or are engaged in research projects involving microbiological studies. Members are expected to adhere to policies mandated by the institute. Memberships can be revoked and not returned if the policies are not followed.

Section B: Dues – ASM-IITD does not charge its members any sort of chapter dues. *Membership fees of \$35 will be collected in advance if a member wishes to attend ASM events outside of ASM-IITD student chapter activities.*

ARTICLE IV: CHAPTER ORGANIZATION

Section A: Active Officers - Active officers are responsible for directing and performing the work of the chapter.

Section B: Verticals - The chapter will be divided into a total of 4 verticals – Administration, Outreach, Sponsorship and Fundraising, and Design.

Section C: Outstanding Board members - No more than 2 individuals will comprise the total number of outstanding board member and active officer positions. Outstanding board members will be selected by incoming officers or by the request of outgoing board members at the end of each year. Outstanding board members are required to hold at least 1 year of membership with an active office position. They will partake in board meetings, balance decisions made by active officers, and help organize chapter activities.

Section D: Board members - Composed of active officers (Section A) and outstanding board members (Section B). All board members can vote. Meet regularly and make decisions about the direction of the chapter and its activities. They may be advised by outstanding board members.

Section E: Faculty/staff advisor(s) – Must be a member of the American Society for Microbiology. As selected annually on a volunteer basis. Advisors provide advice to board members. May partake in any of the meetings.

Section F: Chapter members - Any members who meet the eligibility criteria.

ARTICLE V: ACTIVE OFFICERS

Section A: Officers - The officers of the chapter shall be: Overall Coordinator, Coordinator and Executive. There is a provision for a maximum of 1 Overall Coordinator, 8 Coordinators and 16 Executives as per institute guidelines.

Each vertical will have a maximum of 2 Coordinators and 4 Executives. The Overall Coordinator will be responsible for smooth functioning of all verticals.

Section B: Eligibility – All chapter members are allowed to stand for said positions granted they fulfil the following criteria:

1. The candidate must have a minimum CGPA of 7.0 at the time of application.
2. There must be no disciplinary action on the candidate by the institute.

Bachelor of Technology (4 year):

- The candidate should have completed a minimum of 2 years of study to be eligible for Overall Coordinator/Coordinator.

Bachelor of Technology + Master of Technology (4 +1 year):

- The candidate should have completed a minimum of 2 years of study to be eligible for Overall Coordinator/Coordinator.

Master of Technology:

- The candidate should have completed a minimum of 1 year of study to be eligible for Overall Coordinator/Coordinator.

Master of Science(Research):

- The candidate should have completed a minimum of 1 year of study to be eligible for Overall Coordinator/Coordinator.

PhD Scholars:

- The candidate should have completed a minimum of 1 year of study to be eligible for Overall Coordinator/Coordinator.

Section C: Term – The officers shall serve for one year and their term of office shall begin at the commencement of Semester I. One individual may preside at their position for no longer than two terms for all the duration.

Section D: Vacancy – If a vacancy occurs in the office of Overall Coordinator, one of the Coordinators will be elected to serve as Overall Coordinator. This will be decided by an internal vote among the board members. If a vacancy occurs in the office of Coordinator, the board members reserve the right to nominate one of the chapter members in place by an internal vote.

ARTICLE VI: DUTIES OF OFFICERS

Section A: Overall Coordinator – It shall be the duty of the Overall Coordinator to:

- Preside over meetings.
- Prepare agenda for monthly meetings.
- Attend and/or preside over seminars, outreach events, practice presentations.
- Prepare budget with the help of Coordinator(s).
- Liaison with other organizations on behalf of the chapter to secure financial or professional support.
- Function as tie-breaking vote in board of members vote.
- Promote chapter activities and actively recruit chapter members at every opportunity.

Section B: Coordinator

1. Coordinator (Administration) – It will be the duty of Coordinator (s) (Administration) to:
 - Record all minutes of meetings.
 - Keep a file of all chapter records.
 - Maintain a roster of current members.
 - Issue notices of meetings and reserve meeting spaces at least a week prior to the date of the meeting.
2. Coordinator (Outreach) – It will be the duty of Coordinator (s) (Outreach) to:

- Maintain the social media profile of ASM-IITD.
 - Facilitate communication between IITD and non-IITD entities for conduction of outreach activities.
 - Conduct regular workshops and guest speaker sessions for chapter members, institute residents and external entities.
 - Coordinate with the nearest ASM ambassador.
3. Coordinator (Sponsorship and Fundraising) – It will be the duty of Coordinator (s) (Sponsorship and Fundraising) to:
- Receive all funds and process requests for payment, deposit slip, and officer signature forms.
 - Keep an itemized account of all receipts and expenditures and make reports as directed.
 - Assist with the planning and execution of fundraisers.
 - Make purchases with chapter funds.
4. Coordinator (Design) – It will be the duty of Coordinator (s) (Design) to:
- Design all important posters and pamphlets to be used for outreach activities.
 - Draft official invitations for chapter meetings.
 - Collaborate with the institutional bodies to ensure correct logo usage and acknowledgements.

Section C: Executive – It will be the duty of Executive(s) to:

- Communicate with non-chapter members about any questions, concerns advice regarding the chapter.
- Assist coordinators in their assigned verticals.
- Disseminate important information to chapter members.
- Promote student engagement at all chapter events.

ARTICLE VII: MEETINGS

Section A: Board Meetings – Regular meetings shall be held based on the board members’ need during the academic year. At a minimum, the board shall meet prior to a chapter meeting. Once a year, the board must review the constitution and make any necessary revisions.

Section B: Chapter Meetings - Meeting with the main chapter body held at the frequency at the board members’ discretion (once a month is recommended). Meeting dates and times will be determined by polling the student chapter body to maximize meeting attendance.

Section C: Special Meetings – Special meetings may be called by any board member and are to be held no later than two weeks after announcement.

ARTICLE VIII: RULES OF ORDER

All ASM-IITD members will be expected to follow these basic rules:

- Be respectful under all circumstances to all members or visitors present during meeting discussions.
- Maintain a professional attitude during all ASM-IITD meetings and events to further our development as public-facing microbiologists.
- Be punctual when attending meetings and events.
- ASM-IITD adheres to the IIT Delhi's Initiative for Caste Equity (ICE) Policy and Initiative for Gender Equity and Sensitization (IGES) Policy:

*IIT Delhi aspires to create a friendly and unbiased environment for people from diverse communities. IIT Delhi recognizes the difference between **equality** and **equity**.*

*While **equality** ensures that everyone has the same rights and should thus enjoy equal treatment and non-discrimination, it might obscure the fact that due to historical and sociological factors most people may not have an equitable starting point. The concept of **equity** goes further in ensuring that equality does not remain only a **formal** practice but becomes a **substantive** one. An initiative for equity thus includes the awareness of discrimination and social exclusion faced by people and makes appropriate provisions for providing need-based support. Caste and untouchability have been identified as fundamental **structural barriers** leading to **discrimination** and **exclusion** of SC-ST communities in India. The Indian constitution, therefore, has banned the practice of untouchability and made provisions for protection against discrimination and created reservations in education and jobs. The Initiative for Caste Equity (ICE) works closely with SC-ST Cell at IIT Delhi works towards implementing Government of India reservation policies and ensuring a discrimination-free environment with an aim to build an inclusive community on campus.*

Initiative for Gender Equity and Sensitisation (IGES), under Indian Institute of Technology, Delhi, aims to create a safe and violence-free educational atmosphere for all, irrespective of diversities in identities of gender, sex, caste, class, ethnicity, language, race, disability and sexual orientation. IGES also advocates a zero tolerance policy against sexual harassment.

ARTICLE IX: ADVISORS/SPONSORS

Section A: Selection – There shall be a faculty/staff advisor, who will be selected annually on a volunteer basis. Faculty advisor must be an ASM member.

Section B: Duties – The responsibilities of the faculty advisor shall be to:

- Maintain an awareness of the activities and programs sponsored by the *ASM-IITD* chapter.
- Meet on a regular basis with the board members to discuss upcoming meetings, activities, goals, and problems of the chapter.
- Explain and clarify campus policy and procedures that apply to the chapter.

- Provide direction to board members when necessary regarding meetings, practices, and events.
- Assist the chapter coordinators in monitoring expenditures, fundraising activities, and corporate sponsorship to maintain an accurate and up-to-date account ledger.
- Facilitate communication between board members and IITD administrators as deemed necessary by the board. Advocate for the chapter when appropriate.
- Assist and advise interaction with *ASM* professional activities.

ARTICLE X: AMENDMENTS

Section A: Selection – These bylaws may be amended by a two-thirds majority vote of the chapter membership, to be voted on during a board, chapter, or special meeting.